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Foley Artists

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ver noticed the slight rumbling of the bush that builds up the tension in a horror sequence? Or that

sound of footsteps in an empty hall with a shadow appearing with a knife in a murder mystery film? Well, then, you are already familiar with the career that we will be talking about here. You might not know what the people behind creating those sound effects are called. Well, we have you back. Don't worry. They are called Foley artists. And in this article, we will be talking you through the history of the art, its modern relevance, and how you can build your career as a Foley artist if you want.

IN THE HISTORY BOOKS

Let's not waste any time and cut to the chase. The name foley, very interestingly, comes from an individual whose identity was kept under wraps when

he started working with audio for films. His name was Jack Foley. Born in New York in the year 1981, Foley had reportedly moved to California because he did not like the weather of NYC. There he started working as a stunt double. Time passed, and Foley changed towns and professions before he wrote a number of scripts for Universal studios, which took the shape of silent films. He then also started directing insert shots for his films. These are the shots which are shot by a second filming unit and are usually used to fill in the gaps between the main sequences of a film.

Over time, silent films went out of the equation and sound was added to films for the first time. Foley had remained active and was working actively in Hollywood all these years. After seeing the effect addition of sounds had had on the films that were being made, he called for the addition of sound effects. It was then when Jack Foley started working on sound effects. Recalling his techniques, George Pal told, "Jack added the footsteps, the movement, the sound of various props-all in one track. He used a cane as an adjunct to his own footsteps. With that cane, he could make the footsteps of two to three people. He kept



Jack Foley